

Learning is Fun

Going back to school, but with a difference

Ever since the start of India's first technology media institute, Media One, in September 2002, the offices of Jasubhai Digital Media have been abuzz with excitement. Media One offers hands-on training in Media Management, which includes components relating to technology as well as allied areas such as design, research and production.

The students at Media One are exposed to every aspect of digital media and technology in a practical way. Besides daily assignments, frequent field visits to media and technology companies and lectures from industry professionals, the students put in practical work hours as part of an editorial group, at the Test Centre or Media Studio amongst other things.

Abhiram Iyengar, a Bachelor of Electronics from Karnataka, is from the first batch of Media One students. He recently got his feet wet in the Digit Test Centre. Here's what he had to say: "From the time I joined Media One and was introduced to different departments within Jasubhai Digital Media, the Test Centre was what attracted me the most. The place is full of the latest computer peripherals and is heaven for anybody remotely interested in technology.



Hard at work in the Test Centre (left): A rigorous schedule, unrelenting assignments and lots of fun

Learning the trade from the best in the field (below): Bimal Biswas, a cinematographer with MTV, reveals his bag of tricks

On my first day itself I was assigned a bunch of games to review. Within a matter of hours I'd played every type of game conceivable, from Adventure, Arcade, RPG to FPS and RTS games. And that was not all. I was supposed to write mock reviews on each game I played, taking into account its graphics and sound quality, ease of use of the interface and the



overall gameplay experience. Boy was it fun!

Over the next few weeks, I tested and wrote a number of articles on processors, motherboards, chipsets, and graphics cards. This improved my knowledge on how each component works and the relationship between the various subsystems of a PC. It also gave me an insight on some new technologies on the horizon and a look at how the PC market operates.

I also had the opportunity to attend presentations by various technology companies and attend some press conferences. Currently I'm engaged full time in testing motherboards and learning the nitty gritty of using various benchmarking software. Other than all this, I also learnt what it is to work under constant pressures of deadlines and the importance of working smarter by planning ahead in today's fast paced workplace. All in all, it's been a truly wonderful experience." ■

Gone with the Wind!

The beginning of the New Year is always a good time to undertake new endeavours and head to explore new frontiers. And two of our oldest hands, Veer Kothari and Marco D'Souza, have decided to explore the world beyond the friendly familiar walls of JDM. While they may be just a few names at the bottom of the article for most of you, Sweet Marco, as we like to call our Head of Writers, is infamous around the Navi Mumbai locale for his Indica by day and Quakemobile by night, just as Veer is for his white Astromobile—both being our chariots of choice during late nights at work and other escapades.

Marco leaves behind fond memories of his days as the head of Test Centre, his trusty, well greased keyboard and a screen-

shot showing the word count of his last cover story for Digit: a staggering 16,315 words. Veer, on the other hand, leaves behind a hard-to-fill space as a permanent resident of the JDM premises, the sensibilities of a first aid box and a huge, happy sunflower.

Saying that they will be missed is a gross understatement. We'll probably never come across anyone with the same unerring precision in matters of technology, astronomy and pretty much everything else under the sun as Veer. Or for that matter, we're sure nobody will match up to Marco's charming ways of dissuading us all from working on a weekend.

All the best for the future to these comrades!